

DATA DOCUMENTATION

2026 Nigeria Budget Analysis

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Programme: HNG Internship

Dataset: 2026 Budget

Data source: [Budget office](#)

Format: PDF

Page: 2790

Tools: Excel-Postgres-Tableau

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Nigeria’s 2026 federal budget reveals how the government is balancing administrative responsibilities, debt obligations, and long-term development during a period of economic pressure and rising public demand for better services.

This analysis examined how public funds are distributed across sectors, how much is spent on administration versus development, and which sectors receive the strongest financial attention.

The findings revealed that debt servicing remains one of the largest national obligations, while Economic Management and Security & Defence account for significant portions of total sector allocations. Governance-focused sectors were found to be heavily recurrent spenders, with nearly 90% of some sector budgets allocated to personnel and overhead costs.

In contrast, sectors such as Infrastructure & Transport and Energy & Natural Resources showed interest in capital development projects

Overall, the budget reveals that the sectors affecting day-to-day Nigerian lives are the last to be considered for budgetary allocations.

INTRODUCTION & OBJECTIVE

Nigeria’s 2026 federal budget is a reflection of the government’s priorities, responsibilities, and development ambitions. For millions of Nigerians facing rising living costs, economic uncertainty, and growing demands for better public services, understanding where public money is going has become increasingly important.

This report investigates the structure of Nigeria’s 2026 budget to understand how national resources are distributed across sectors, how much is allocated to government operations compared to development, and what these spending patterns reveal about the country’s broader fiscal priorities.

The analysis aims to answer one major question: **Where is Nigeria's money going?**

DATA OVERVIEW

DATA DICTIONARY – MINISTRY/SECTOR ALLOCATION (TABLE 1)

Column Name	Data Type	Description	Example
NO	Integer	Unique row identifier	1
CODE	Integer	Unique code assigned	111

		to each Ministry, Department, or Agency (MDA)	
MDA	Text	Name of the Ministry, Department, or Agency receiving allocation	Ministry of Defence, Ministry of Sport and etc.
SECTOR	Text	Sector category the MDA belongs to	Security & Defence, Sport and etc.
PERSONNEL	Numeric	Amount allocated for staff salaries and wage	1,704,772,278
OVERHEAD	Numeric	Amount allocated for operational and administrative expenses	1045585105
CAPITAL	Numeric	Amount allocated for projects, infrastructure, and development	748400892

Retained Independent Revenue and AID and Grant Funded was excluded from the dataset because the value was 0 across the rows.

Sector variable was added to categorize the MDA variable.

DATA QUALITY & DECISION

Table	Data Quality	Volume	Decision
Ministry/Section Allocation	Data contamination	22 rows	Manually fixing the value to original variable & delete the empty cell while fixing data contamination.
Ministry/Sector Allocation	Incorrect Datatype	9 columns	Handling it by giving it the columns the appropriate datatype
Ministry/Sector Allocation	Data inconsistency	44 rows	Replacing value with space
Ministry/Sector Allocation	Extra Spacing	Text Column	Using Trim(clean()) function to

			remove extra spacing
Ministry/Sector Allocation	Unwanted column	2 column	Removing unwanted column because is not relevant to analysis
Ministry/Sector Allocation	Duplicate value	0	No duplicate found across the rows in the dataset
National Budget Categories	Duplicate value	0	No duplicate found across the rows in the dataset

METHODOLOGY

The analysis was conducted using the 2026 Nigerian budget allocation dataset containing MDAs, sectors, and expenditure categories. Data cleaning was performed to correct formatting inconsistencies, remove duplicates, and handle missing values. MDAs were properly classified into sectors to improve consistency. The cleaned dataset was analyzed using Excel and SQL to identify sectoral allocation patterns and spending priorities.

Stage	Tool	Activity Performed	Purpose
Data Source	Online (PDF file)	Downloaded the 2026 Budget PDF file from the Budget Office	To gather relevant data for analysis
Data Extraction	ilovePDF	Used iLovePDF to split and extract relevant sections from the PDF document	To be able to convert it using Excel Power Query
Data Conversion	Excel (Power Query)	Converted the extracted PDF data into CSV format using Excel Power Query	To transform the data into an analyzable form
Data Importation	Postgres	Imported CSV file to Postgres	To prepare data processing and analysis.
Data Cleaning	Excel and Postgres	Corrected inconsistent entries	To improve data accuracy and consistency

Data Fomattting	Excel and Postgres	Standardized column formats and corrected split MDA names	To ensure uniformity across the dataset
Handling Missing Values	Postgres	Checked for null or blank value	To improve data completeness
Sector Classification	Excel		To enable accurate sector-based analysis
Data Analysis	Postgres		
Data Visualization	Tableau		
Insight Generation	Postgres and Tableau		

The analysis focuses on operational spending, sector allocation patterns, development-oriented expenditure, and citizen-impact sectors to answer one major question:

WHERE IS NIGERIA'S MONEY GOING?

Data Preparation and Cleaning

The analysis was conducted using:

Ministry Sector Allocation Table

National Budget Categories Table

To ensure consistency and analytical reliability, the following data cleaning processes were performed:

- Text fields were trimmed to remove unnecessary spaces.
- All relevant text values were standardized to lowercase formatting.
- Null values were checked across both datasets..
- Sector and budget category labels were reviewed for consistency.